

Career Planning and Management

Module 1: Introduction to Career Planning

Exam Ready Notes — CS / BCA Students

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Define the Starting Point

What is Career Planning?

Career planning is a **continuous process** of setting career goals and identifying the means to achieve them. It involves self-assessment, exploration of opportunities, decision-making, and action.

Why Define a Starting Point?

Before planning a career path, one must understand *where they currently stand*. This includes:

- Current skills, knowledge, and qualifications
- Personal interests and values
- Strengths and weaknesses (Self-Assessment)
- Past experiences and achievements

Key Steps to Define the Starting Point

1. **Self-Assessment** — Know yourself: aptitudes, interests, personality, values.
2. **Environmental Scanning** — Know the job market, industry trends, opportunities.
3. **Gap Analysis** — Compare current state with desired future state.
4. **Goal Setting** — Set short-term and long-term career goals (SMART goals).

SWOT Analysis in Career Planning

Strengths	Weaknesses	Opportunities	Threats
Internal positive traits	Internal limitations	External favorable factors	External challenges

Exam Tip: SWOT is commonly asked. Remember: Strengths & Weaknesses = **Internal**; Opportunities & Threats = **External**.

Career Anchors

Definition

Career Anchors is a concept introduced by **Edgar H. Schein** (MIT). A career anchor is a *combination of self-perceived talents, motives, and values* that a person would not give up even if forced to make a difficult career choice.

In simple words: It is what *holds you back* to certain kinds of work — your career identity.

The Eight Career Anchors (Schein)

1. **Technical/Functional Competence**

The person wants to be an expert in their technical field. They derive identity from their professional skills.

Example: A programmer who loves coding and wants to be the best developer.

2. **General Managerial Competence**

Motivated by the desire to lead, manage, and be responsible for outcomes. Integrates

efforts of others.

Example: Someone who aspires to become a CEO or project manager.

3. **Autonomy/Independence**

Values freedom to define their own work. Resists rules and constraints.

Example: Freelance developer or consultant.

4. **Security/Stability**

Prioritizes job security and financial stability over challenge or advancement.

Example: Government job or large corporation with stable income.

5. **Entrepreneurial Creativity**

Driven to create new products, services, or organizations. Driven by ownership and innovation.

Example: Tech startup founder.

6. **Service/Dedication to a Cause**

Values the opportunity to serve others or contribute to society.

Example: Working in NGO, healthcare, or education sector.

7. **Pure Challenge**

Motivated by solving seemingly impossible problems. Needs constant challenge.

Example: Competitive coder, problem-solver roles.

8. **Lifestyle Integration**

Wants to balance career with personal life. Seeks flexibility.

Example: Work-from-home jobs, flexible-hour roles.

Exam Tip: Schein's Career Anchors = **8 anchors**. Most commonly asked: Technical Competence, Managerial, Autonomy, Security, Entrepreneurial.

Behavioural Models

Overview

Behavioural models help understand how a person's *behaviour, attitude, and personality* influence their career choices and workplace performance.

Key Behavioural Models

3.2.1 1. Bandura's Social Learning Theory

- People learn by **observing others** (role models).
- Key concept: **Self-Efficacy** — belief in one's own ability to succeed.
- High self-efficacy $\Rightarrow$ higher career aspirations and persistence.

3.2.2 2. Locus of Control (Julian Rotter)

- **Internal Locus of Control:** Person believes they control their own destiny.
Result: More proactive in career planning.
- **External Locus of Control:** Person believes external forces (luck, fate) control outcomes.
Result: Less proactive, may feel helpless.

Exam Tip: Internal LOC people are better career planners.

3.2.3 3. Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs

Motivation-based model; people are motivated by unfulfilled needs.

1. Physiological (basic survival)
2. Safety (security)
3. Social/Belonging (relationships)
4. Esteem (recognition)
5. Self-Actualization (reaching full potential)

Career relevance: Career goals align with the level of need currently dominant.

3.2.4 4. Holland's RIASEC Model (also under Personality, see Section 4)

Behaviour is influenced by personality type which maps to career environment. (Covered in next section.)

3.2.5 5. Cognitive Behavioural Theory in Career Counselling

- Negative self-talk and dysfunctional beliefs block career development.
- Correcting faulty thinking $\Rightarrow$ better career decisions.
- Example belief: "I am not good enough for a tech job" $\Rightarrow$ challenge and reframe it.

Personality Typology

Definition

Personality typology classifies individuals into types based on psychological traits. In career planning, it helps match a person's personality to suitable careers.

Holland's RIASEC Model (John Holland)

Holland proposed that people and work environments can be classified into **6 types**:

Type	Traits	Career Examples
R — Realistic	Practical, mechanical, hands-on	Engineer, Mechanic, Farmer
I — Investigative	Analytical, intellectual, curious	Scientist, Programmer, Researcher
A — Artistic	Creative, expressive, imaginative	Designer, Writer, Musician
S — Social	Helpful, empathetic, cooperative	Teacher, Counsellor, HR Manager
E — Enterprising	Ambitious, persuasive, leadership	Manager, Entrepreneur, Lawyer
C — Conventional	Organized, detail-oriented, structured	Accountant, Data Analyst, Banker

Exam Tip: Memorize the acronym **RIASEC** and one career example per type.

Myers-Briggs Type Indicator (MBTI)

Based on Carl Jung's theory. Classifies people on **4 dimensions**:

Dimension	Poles
Energy Source	Extroversion (E) vs. Introversion (I)
Information Processing	Sensing (S) vs. Intuition (N)
Decision Making	Thinking (T) vs. Feeling (F)
Lifestyle Preference	Judging (J) vs. Perceiving (P)

This gives **16 personality types** (e.g., INTJ, ENFP). Used in career counselling and team management.

Big Five Personality Model (OCEAN)

Trait	High Score	Low Score
O — Openness	Creative, curious	Conventional, routine-oriented
C — Conscientiousness	Organized, disciplined	Careless, impulsive
E — Extraversion	Sociable, assertive	Reserved, solitary
A — Agreeableness	Cooperative, trusting	Competitive, suspicious
N — Neuroticism	Anxious, emotional	Calm, stable

Exam Tip: Mnemonic for Big Five = **OCEAN**. Conscientiousness is the strongest predictor of job performance.

Type A and Type B Personality

- **Type A:** Competitive, time-conscious, impatient, high-achieving. Prone to stress.
Suitable: Fast-paced careers, leadership roles, sales.
- **Type B:** Relaxed, patient, creative, less competitive.
Suitable: Research, creative fields, counselling.

Quick Revision Summary

- **Starting Point:** Self-assessment → SWOT → Gap Analysis → Goal Setting
- **Career Anchors (Schein):** 8 anchors — Technical, Managerial, Autonomy, Security, Entrepreneurial, Service, Challenge, Lifestyle
- **Behavioural Models:** Bandura (Self-Efficacy), Rotter (LOC), Maslow (Needs), CBT (Beliefs)
- **Personality Models:**
 - Holland's RIASEC (6 types)
 - MBTI (16 types, 4 dimensions)
 - Big Five OCEAN
 - Type A vs Type B

“Know yourself, know your options, plan your path.”